Unit 3 - Impact of IT
Assignment 1

Task 2 (D1) - Evaluate the impact of IT developments on an organisation

Do the positive impacts outweigh the potential negative impacts? Consider as many positive and negative impacts as you can.

When upgrading a large office with new OS and integrated software would, of course, cost the business money to do. Such as buying licenses for each one of the OS and software that would be added in the large office. The positive side to this is that the workers have much more newer and more refined OS and software to do their work in, which in most cases, is a much better improvement to the previous versions of the OS and software.

However, the downside to this is that it would cost the business several thousands of pounds to replace the OS and software due to the expensive price the newer and more refined software have. Another negative is that the employees might not know how to operate the new OS or the new software, which would cause problems in the workplace or training would be needed to operate the new OS or software, which would be another expense for the business.

Whether the positive impacts outweigh the negatives is debatable, the negatives would heavily outweigh the positives if it was a small business or if it was a business with very low income, so it wouldn't be worth it. However, if it was a much larger company with better income, the upgrade of a new office wouldn't be as impactful, so a change might be worth it due to the much better workload and efficiency the newer and improved software and OS could give to an employee.

Improving the processing power and storage capacity for the employees for their work efficiency may seem like a very positive impact, and it is. The reason for this is that the much more improved processing power would increase the overall speed on the PC and it's ability to run many programs simultaneously, giving the employee the ability to multitask. This would increase efficiency due to the less time taken to produce the work needed.

However, the downside to this is also the expenses the business would be impacted by. So, in this case again, for a small business the negatives overweigh the positives by a lot. To a much larger business, the positives and negatives are much more evened out, meaning that an upgrade to storage and processing power might be an option.

Whether the positives outweigh the negatives is yet again determined whether the business has enough expenses to make the negatives not as impactful as it would be if the business had very little profits.

The impact of having higher network speeds and WIFI would have a mostly positive impact towards the customer service due to the better reliability and faster loading speeds that the higher network speed provides. This would be very beneficial to a business that hosts its own website with its own servers, if their network speed is very high for their servers. Not only would the business be much more responsive, but the customers connecting to the business's website or forums would also be very responsive.

The negative side to this is just like the previous negatives, the expenses it has towards the business. Yet again, upgrading the network and WIFI wouldn't be a very viable option if you are a small business or have very little expenses. However, to a large business, this upgrade would be very beneficial due to the fact that a higher network and WIFI speed would be much more reliable and faster to use.

Whether the positives outweigh the negatives yet again depends whether the business could afford this upgrade without it impacting the business itself due to the amount of the profits wasted for this type of upgrade.

Do the financial impacts, profits and costs make implementing the changes worthwhile?

As I mentioned before, the financial impacts that a small business would have on implementing these upgrades will depends how much the upgrades would cost and how much profit the business is making in order to afford these upgrades.

For upgrading a large office with the OS and software, it would cost the business a lot of money due to the high prices of newer and improved software and OS. Whether it would be worthwhile on implementing these upgrades aren't very predictable, it could either improve the business a lot or it would of been a meaningless upgrade that lost the profits to the business, putting it at risk. It wouldn’t be worthwhile for other types of offices for example a public school, since wasting a lot of money on an OS and software and not making back the money wouldn't be worth it

For improving the processing power and storage capacity of the PCs on a business can also have the same impact as I stated before. For a small business it would be too much wasted profits and would put the business in a very vulnerable position. Whether it would be worthwhile is also unpredictable because it could either benefit the business a lot due to the efficiency of the work produced, or it would be a useless upgrade and it would of wasted the profits used for this upgrade.

For the higher network speeds and WIFI it is the same impacts are the rest. A small business would have too much of an impact and it would be very vulnerable, and a larger one would have a chance of being improved by this upgrade. Whether it is worthwhile to do this upgrade is debatable, because having higher network speeds may not be as costly as the others that have been mentioned, it still costs the business money. If a big business has a huge customer

service and the network keeps or crashing or is very unresponsive, then having this upgrade is a priority. However, if the customer service works perfectly without little to no reported problems, then an upgrade would be irrational.

Will the changes create risks for an organisation? What knock on effects may happen?

For upgrading a large office with newer OS and software, the knock on effect it would have depends how much of the profits of the business was impacted or whether it is a necessary upgrade to have. If a business does upgrade it, it could either improve the amount of work produced and the newer software would create much more refined work for the business. However, the other effect may be that the staff would either complain because they don't know how to use it or it could of cost the business's profits too much and put it in a risky position.

If a business doesn't upgrade, it wouldn't be making work as efficiently and at a much better quality than if it was upgraded. However, the staff is used to the older OS and software and be much more comfortable on the current state of the OS and the software.

For improving the processing power and storage capacity, the knock on effect that would happen would also depends on how much money the business can put into this upgrade so they can still work as a business properly without being at risk of being bankrupt. If the business does get this upgrade, it could either benefit from it and have much better multitasking and workload from the employees, or it could either be an irrational upgrade and would of been a waste of money for the business.

If a business doesn't upgrade, the ability for the employees to multitask and contain a lot of work wouldn't be as much as the upgrade. However, the business wouldn't of wasted a lot of money on upgrading the PC of every employee and reduce the chance of the business being bankrupt.

For upgrading the network and WIFI speeds, the knock on effect that would have depends on how fast and reliable their network is and how much money they can waste on this upgrade. If the business does get this upgrade, it could go in different ways. For example, the network speeds would've improved the customer service and the staff because it is much more reliable and faster than it previously was. However, the upgrade may not be needed because the network and WIFI speed of the business may be good enough to handle the tasks needed.

If the business doesn't upgrade, either the business might suffer from the slow network and WIFI and the customer service and feedback may be very unreliable and slow, which could give the business a bad reputation, putting it in a big risk of being shut down. However, the business may of not needed the upgrade in the first place and the network and WIFI would still be working at a reliable and fast enough rate to not get such a bad reputation and risk of being shut down, and no money would be spent because no upgrade was done.

In conclusion, these developments in ICT and Computing could impact your organisation depending on whether you are a small business with very little profits or a big business with a lot of profits. If you are a small business with little profit, it wouldn't be worth it to upgrade any of your ICT and Computing because the significant risk that is very possible will outweigh the positives of the upgrades.

However, if you are a big business with a lot of profits, upgrading the ICT and Computing part of the business would be very beneficial without being weighed down by the negatives as much as it would to a small business. Also, having better ICT and Computing in the business will improve the efficiency of work done, due to the fact that more work can be done and stored more by one person at a much shorter amount of time.

In comparison to the newer developments and the older ones, the newer ones would be an almost definite choice if the business can spend a lot of money without being too heavily impacted.